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Software | North America

Are Consumer Agents a Potential Tailwind for Vertical Software?

Consumer agents could emerge as a tailwind for select vertical software vendors by reducing friction between consumer intent and transactions. We see TTAN, CCC, and VIA as best exposed through higher service demand, claims volumes, and transit utilization, respectively.

Following the viral launch of Muse and Instinct, investors have started to ask about the potential impact to vertical software, especially for vendors with exposure to consumer end-markets. While it is still early days within the adoption curve of consumer agents, we see three companies within our Vertical & Systems coverage group that could see the most direct impact from consumer agent proliferation over time. That being said, we have not seen any evidence yet that consumer agents are having an impact on these companies. This is purely a conceptual exercise on what makes the most sense logically to us.

Who Is Best Exposed?

ServiceTitan (TTAN; OW, \$92 PT): ServiceTitan could be a direct beneficiary as consumer agents reduce the friction involved in finding and booking local services. A consumer could ask an agent to find an HVAC technician who has availability tomorrow, compare providers on price and reviews, and book the job without the consumer ever having to search or call around. Given how fragmented local services remain, this could drive incremental jobs for trades businesses/technicians as the barrier for consumers to address residential issues comes down. More jobs for ServiceTitan customers translates directly into higher Gross Transaction Value (GTV).

CCC Intelligent Solutions (CCC; OW, \$9 PT): CCC could benefit if consumer agents increase the percentage of accidents that ultimately get reported as insurance claims. Some lower- and mid-severity accidents likely go unreported today because consumers are unsure whether filing is worth it or simply do not want to deal with the claims process. This should matter most for accidents where filing is economically rational but friction or uncertainty keeps the consumer from doing so today. If agents bring even a portion of those unreported accidents into the claims process, that would represent incremental claims volume flowing through CCC's network.

Via Transportation (VIA; OW \$33 PT): Via could benefit as consumer agents increasingly make transportation decisions based on price, travel time, and convenience. If a consumer asks an agent for the fastest or cheapest way to get somewhere, the agent could surface a Via-powered microtransit or public-transit

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SOFTWARE	
North America	
Industry View	Attractive

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option that the consumer may not have known existed. This could be particularly helpful for Via because microtransit has a discovery problem: consumers know to check Uber, Lyft, or Google Maps, but they may have no idea that a local Via-powered service is available for a fraction of the cost or might even be faster. Agents should be much better at finding and comparing that long-tail transportation supply. Higher ridership does not translate directly into Via revenue, which is generally tied to vehicles and vehicle-hours rather than rides, but better ridership could lead local governments to add vehicles, extend service hours, expand coverage, and ultimately spend more with Via.

What are Muse and Instinct? *Muse and Instinct are personal AI agents designed to complete tasks on users' behalf, rather than simply answer questions. Meta launched Muse on September 8, 2026, through its app and WhatsApp; Instinct (private) is largely accessed by iMessage. Agents can navigate websites, fill out forms, book travel, and help negotiate bills, requesting approval for actions such as purchases. Both added outbound calling in mid-September through limited rollouts, allowing agents to contact businesses about reservations, appointments, and customer-service issues.*

Valuation Methodology and Risks

CCC Intelligent Solutions Holdings Inc (CCC.O)

18x CY27 uFCF of \$380MM. 18x EV/CY27 FCF is ~in line with the SMID software mean at ~15 EV/FCF and a discount to the Vertical Software average at 20x

Risks to Upside

- Faster ramp of Emerging Solutions
- New product innovation
- Expansion to new segments in P&C Insurance
- >100 bps of annual margin expansion.

Risks to Downside

- Customer growth slows materially
- Net retention rate drops on headwinds to cross sell/upsell motion
- Increasing competition requiring more significant investments, as well as M&A capping margin expansion
- Private Equity owner becomes a more active seller.

ServiceTitan Inc (TTAN.O)

Based off of 20x Base Case 2035e FCF, discounted back at 11.1%. 20x is slightly below scaled vertical software peers and implies 7.4x EV/CY27 Revenue or 0.5x EV/GP/Growth.

Risks to Upside

- Expansion into new markets and trades drive significant new customer acquisition
- Pro product attach continues to improve as added AI functionalities drive material improvements in customer ROI

Risks to Downside

- Commercial market expansion proves more challenging
- Core Residential trade market penetration reaches a ceiling
- R&D investments don't drive a meaningful shift in Pro product adoption

Via Transportation Inc (VIA.N)

Based off of 12.3x Base Case 2035e FCF, discounted back at 11.8%, implying 9x CY27e Gross Profit, a slight discount compared to the SMID software average.

Risks to Upside

- New vertical and international expansion contribute earlier than expected
- End customers are more willing to adopt new technologies

Risks to Downside

- High mix of low margin services sustains current levels, pressuring gross margin performance and elongating the path to 50% gross margins
- Seasonality and lumpiness of RFP's impacts cadence of customer additions

- High end market exposure (>90% of rev from government)

Disclosure Section

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(as of August 31, 2026)

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1555	42%	450	48%	29%	767	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1577	43%	395	42%	25%	770	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	1	0%	33%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	559	15%	93	10%	17%	216	12%
Total	3,694		939			1754	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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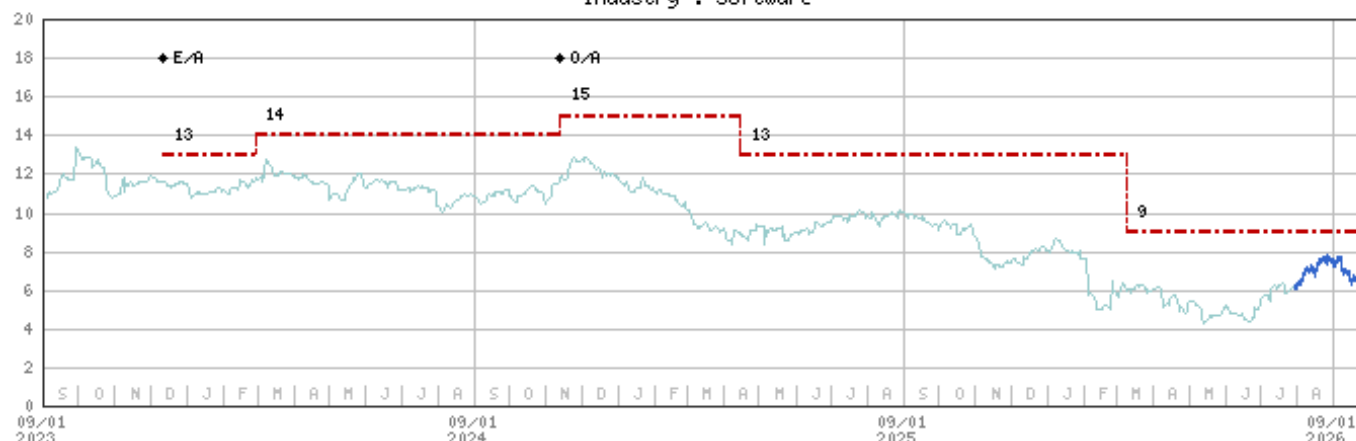
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Stock Price, Price Target and Rating History (See Rating Definitions)

CCC Intelligent Solutions Holdings Inc (CCC.O) - As of 09/22/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Software



Stock Rating History: 12/12/23 : E/A; 11/13/24 : O/A

Price Target History: 12/12/23 : 13; 2/28/24 : 14; 11/13/24 : 15; 4/15/25 : 13; 3/10/26 : 9

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target — No Price Target Assigned (NA)

Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —

Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View

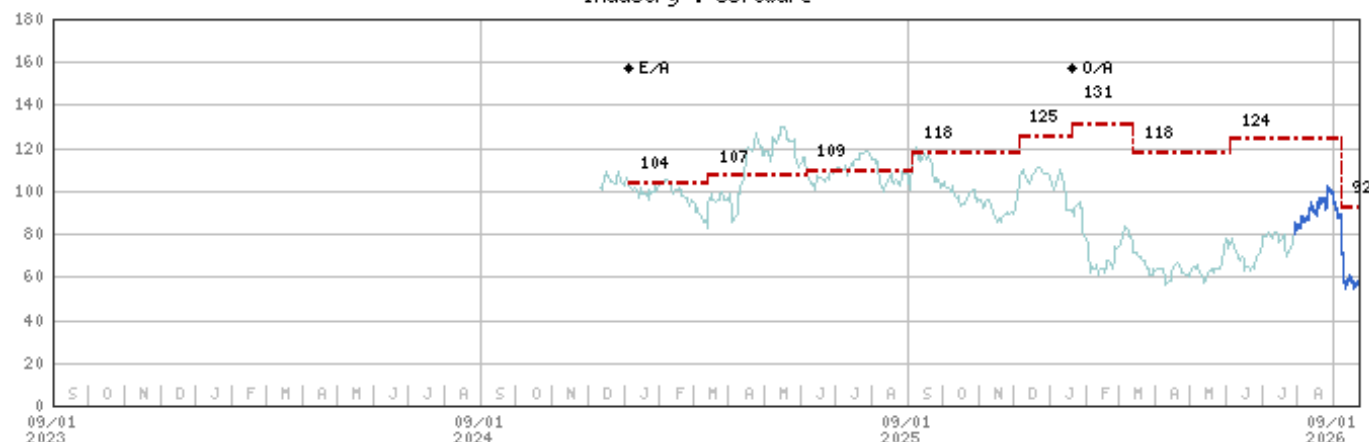
Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)

Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

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ServiceTitan Inc (TTAN.O) - As of 09/22/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Software



Stock Rating History: 1/6/25 : E/A; 1/20/26 : O/A

Price Target History: 1/6/25 : 104; 3/14/25 : 107; 6/6/25 : 109; 9/5/25 : 118; 12/5/25 : 125; 1/20/26 : 131; 3/13/26 : 118; 6/4/26 : 124; 9/8/26 : 92

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Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)

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Via Transportation Inc (VIA.N) - As of 09/22/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Software



Stock Rating History: 10/7/25 : E/A; 1/20/26 : O/A

Price Target History: 10/7/25 : 53; 1/20/26 : 41; 2/27/26 : 28; 5/12/26 : 24; 9/20/26 : 33

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target --- No Price Target Assigned (NA)

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INDUSTRY COVERAGE: Software

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (09/22/2026)
Adam Wood		
Adobe Inc. (ADBE.O)	U (07/21/2026)	\$238.25
Atlassian Corporation PLC (TEAM.O)	O (01/13/2020)	\$188.65
Intuit (INTU.O)	E (07/21/2026)	\$292.35
Microsoft (MSFT.O)	O (07/21/2026)	\$498.00
Salesforce, Inc. (CRM.N)	E (07/21/2026)	\$233.28
Samsara Inc (IOT.N)	E (03/23/2023)	\$38.26
ServiceNow Inc (NOW.N)	O (09/24/2025)	\$137.00
Shopify Inc (SHOP.O)	O (04/19/2024)	\$147.74
Workday Inc (WDAY.O)	U (07/21/2026)	\$188.23
Chris Quintero		
BILL Holdings Inc (BILL.N)	E (06/10/2025)	\$46.49
Blackline Inc (BL.O)	E (07/21/2026)	\$27.85
Box Inc (BOX.N)	E (05/21/2024)	\$32.87
CCC Intelligent Solutions Holdings Inc (CCC.O)	O (11/13/2024)	\$6.57
Descartes Systems Group Inc (DSGX.O)	O (01/15/2026)	\$78.86
DocuSign Inc (DOCU.O)	E (01/16/2024)	\$66.76
Manhattan Associates Inc. (MANH.O)	E (10/21/2025)	\$207.09
Navan Inc (NAVN.O)	O (11/24/2025)	\$20.97
ServiceTitan Inc (TTAN.O)	O (01/20/2026)	\$61.56
SPS Commerce Inc (SPSC.O)	U (07/21/2026)	\$81.48
Vertex Inc. (VERX.O)	E (07/21/2026)	\$11.79
Via Transportation Inc (VIA.N)	O (01/20/2026)	\$28.37
Elizabeth Porter, CFA		
Amplitude Inc. (AMPL.O)	O (01/15/2026)	\$13.14
Asana Inc (ASAN.N)	U (05/20/2025)	\$9.08
Autodesk (ADSK.O)	O (08/23/2024)	\$219.62
Figma Inc (FIG.N)	E (08/25/2025)	\$21.80

Five9 Inc (FIVN.O)	E (10/10/2022)	\$38.65
Freshworks Inc (FRSH.O)	E (10/18/2021)	\$12.42
GoDaddy Inc (GDDY.N)	E (07/19/2021)	\$98.24
HubSpot, Inc. (HUBS.N)	O (03/21/2023)	\$217.88
Klaviyo, Inc (KVYO.N)	O (04/29/2026)	\$15.87
Liveramp Holdings Inc (RAMP.N)	E (01/13/2025)	\$37.55
monday.com Ltd (MNDY.O)	O (08/12/2025)	\$84.95
NICE Ltd. (NICE.O)	E (07/21/2026)	\$118.29
Octave Intelligence Plc (OCTV.O)	E (09/17/2026)	\$19.37
RingCentral Inc (RNG.N)	E (08/08/2023)	\$79.73
Sprinklr Inc (CXM.N)	E (07/19/2021)	\$5.38
Sprout Social Inc (SPT.O)	E (11/17/2020)	\$9.88
Toast, Inc. (TOST.N)	O (12/16/2021)	\$29.65
Twilio Inc (TWLO.N)	O (02/24/2025)	\$284.53
Wix.Com Ltd (WIX.O)	E (07/21/2026)	\$80.10
Zeta Global Holdings Corp (ZETA.N)	E (08/01/2024)	\$30.13
Zoom Communications (ZM.O)	E (10/11/2022)	\$90.95
ZoomInfo Technologies Inc (GTM.O)	E (02/01/2024)	\$3.88
Meryl R Thomas, CFA		
Lightspeed Commerce Inc. (LSPD.N)	E (02/18/2021)	\$9.61
Meta A Marshall		
Check Point Software Technologies Ltd. (CHKP.O)	E (10/16/2023)	\$137.13
CrowdStrike Holdings Inc (CRWD.O)	O (03/10/2026)	\$250.06
Fortinet Inc. (FTNT.O)	E (07/21/2026)	\$174.26
Gen Digital Inc. (GEN.O)	E (06/07/2024)	\$27.29
Netskope, Inc. (NTSK.O)	O (10/13/2025)	\$18.55
Okta, Inc. (OKTA.O)	O (12/02/2024)	\$196.62
Palo Alto Networks Inc (PANW.O)	O (10/10/2017)	\$374.57
Qualys Inc (QLYS.O)	U (02/09/2021)	\$183.32
Rapid7 Inc (RPD.O)	U (07/21/2026)	\$12.85
SailPoint Inc (SAIL.O)	O (09/02/2025)	\$21.37
SentinelOne, Inc. (S.N)	E (12/02/2024)	\$23.85
Tenable Holdings Inc (TENB.O)	E (12/02/2024)	\$35.91
Varonis Systems, Inc. (VRNS.O)	E (01/26/2026)	\$47.29
Zscaler Inc (ZS.O)	E (04/22/2026)	\$210.18
Ryan Lountzis		
CoreWeave (CRWV.O)	E (04/22/2025)	\$86.76
Nebius Group NV (NBIS.O)	E (01/15/2026)	\$236.12
Sanjit K Singh		
Akamai Technologies, Inc. (AKAM.O)	O (01/12/2026)	\$118.34
Appian Corp (APPN.O)	E (04/30/2026)	\$36.90
C3.ai (AI.N)	U (01/04/2021)	\$10.85
Cloudflare Inc (NET.N)	O (12/02/2024)	\$353.00
Datadog, Inc. (DDOG.O)	O (01/12/2026)	\$247.48
DigitalOcean Holdings Inc (DOCN.N)	O (01/16/2025)	\$146.00
Dynatrace Inc (DT.N)	O (08/25/2026)	\$57.20
Elastic NV (ESTC.N)	E (07/21/2026)	\$89.22
GitLab Inc (GTLB.O)	E (01/12/2026)	\$48.82
JFrog Ltd. (FROG.O)	E (07/21/2026)	\$89.95
MongoDB Inc (MDB.O)	O (04/12/2023)	\$427.69
Oracle Corporation (ORCL.N)	E (01/15/2019)	\$149.20
PagerDuty, Inc. (PD.N)	U (07/21/2026)	\$14.48
Palantir Technologies Inc. (PLTR.O)	E (02/04/2025)	\$184.99
Snowflake Inc. (SNOW.N)	O (06/24/2025)	\$336.59

UiPath Inc (PATH.N)	E (09/07/2022)	\$13.25
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